Design elements & principles

National 5 · Design & DTP · Worksheet

GRAPHICS WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ explain line, colour, alignment, contrast, dominance, depth and unity, referring to specific items
- ☐ name the type of alignment between items

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A poster for a smartwatch has a large white "65%" over a black background and a "BUY NOW" button in the same white.

1 Explain how two design elements or principles have been used to create visual impact. (2 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

The white "65%" contrasts strongly with the black background, so it stands out ✓. It is also the largest element on the poster, so it dominates and is the first thing the viewer reads ✓.

Why answers lose marks

"Contrast and dominance have been used to make it stand out."

0 marks: no items in the poster are referred to.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

A web page has a heading, a block of body text and three images down the right-hand side.

2 Describe two examples of alignment used in the layout. (2 marks)

Sentence starters

One … is …, which means …

Another … is …, so …

Word bank

aligned · images · vertically · captions · bottom · centrally · heading

Tip: 2 marks = 2 separate, developed points.

YOU DO **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) Which answer would score for alignment?
☐ The items are aligned ☐ The heading and body text are left aligned ☐ Alignment makes it neat ☐ It is balanced

b) Repeating the same font and colour across a layout creates...
☐ Contrast ☐ Unity ☐ Depth ☐ Dominance

c) The largest, brightest item that is seen first shows...
☐ Unity ☐ Dominance ☐ White space ☐ Alignment

d) A drop shadow behind an image mainly creates...
☐ Depth ☐ Rhythm ☐ Unity ☐ Alignment

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Dominance**	____	**A** The item that stands out most and is seen first.
2. **Contrast**	____	**B** Items look like they belong together: repeated colour, font, shape.
3. **Unity**	____	**C** Differences in colour, size, shape or weight that make items stand out.

5 Explain what is meant by ‘Depth’. (2 marks)

6 Explain what is meant by ‘Alignment’. (2 marks)

Check and reflect
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?